

to their Macs and PCs to give their devices meaning - now every device was but an autonomous extension of the cloud. The desire to extend this to a real time seamless inter-device existence has however taken its time to become a reality, and with iOS 8 and the Mac OS X Yosemite we can see it finally happening. Continuity is the new feature launched by Apple that connects all supported Apple devices together using localised Wi-Fi and Bluetooth 4 connections. This enables users to receive phone calls and messages on any of their machines as long as the iPhone is within range. This works with more than iMessage and FaceTime, and also extends to standard mobile calls and SMSes. The components of this near invisible set up demand that the hardware devices have Bluetooth 4, mobile device have iOS 8 and the computers be running on Mac OS X Yosemite. As of now Yosemite is still in public beta testing but is expected to be rolled out by October 2014 just in time for the new iPad and Apple Watch.

Handoff

Handoff is the name given by Apple to the ability to seamlessly transition your tasks and activities across different Apple machines. For example if you are working on a document on your Mac computer and have to head out, you can just resume working from where you left off on the Mac on your iPad or Macbook. This technology has been optimised for iPhone 5S and 6 series of phones, along with the iPad Mini, iMac and MacBook Air. Using this feature you can “Handoff” an ongoing iMessage chat on your Mac to your iPhone as you leave the house without any interruption in service. Handoff is recognised by a small icon in the lower left corner of the screen. When we slide the icon upwards the device passcode or finger scan is required, which then opens the related application.

Hotspot, AirDrop and Bluetooth 4

The necessity of the seamless user experience is very evident in iOS 8 and the current generation of Apple hardware. Something as simple as Mobile Hotspot has also been seamlessly integrated so that users no longer have to go to the Settings menu to activate it. The regularly paired device will automatically see the host network and connect to it when commanded to do so from the “Select Network” option.

Similarly the AirDrop feature from iOS 7 has also been opened up to a fair degree. While previously it wasn't possible to send photos, videos and other content from your iPad or iPhone to a friend's Mac using AirDrop now